

X's biggest embarrassment, now a game

X suspends about 208 bot accounts a minute (reported, Apr 2026) · Spotting the fake is already entertainment on X · X Arcade turns it into a two-player game

~208/min

BOT SUSPENSIONS, REPORTED

Decoy

FLAGSHIP CARTRIDGE

30s

ONE ROUND

Nobody owns games at X this week

- X has never shipped a game in twenty years
- Musk promised an xAI-studio AI game by end of 2026
- That promise is still unshipped
- X's head of product resigned on 5 August
- WeChat shows mini-games can anchor a super app
- Source: 7 Aug research sweep, public reporting

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GAMES SHIPPED BY X

Unshipped

THE 2026 PROMISE

Aug 5

PRODUCT HEAD RESIGNED

Decoy: spot the machine in 30 seconds

- One real trending thread, pulled live from X
- Four real replies, read verbatim from the thread
- One Grok-written imposter hidden among them
- Two players race to tap the fake
- Reveal shows real authors and the imposter's rationale



6

ROUNDS BUILT LIVE, 7 AUG

5

GROK VOICE HOST LINES

1

SHARE CARD, IMAGINE

- TWO PLAYERS, ONE ROOM

Let's play

Room code GROK · First correct tap wins

GROK

ROOM CODE

30s

ON THE CLOCK

- X_SEARCH TO REVEAL

Live thread in, **five gates** before play



Gates rejected 1 of 6 rounds built today (G_SOURCE + G_URL), so 5 serve

Proven offline: full two-player round, zero network egress (artifacts/integration_trace.txt)

42s

X_SEARCH PROBE

6.5s

IMAGE GEN PROBE

1.78s

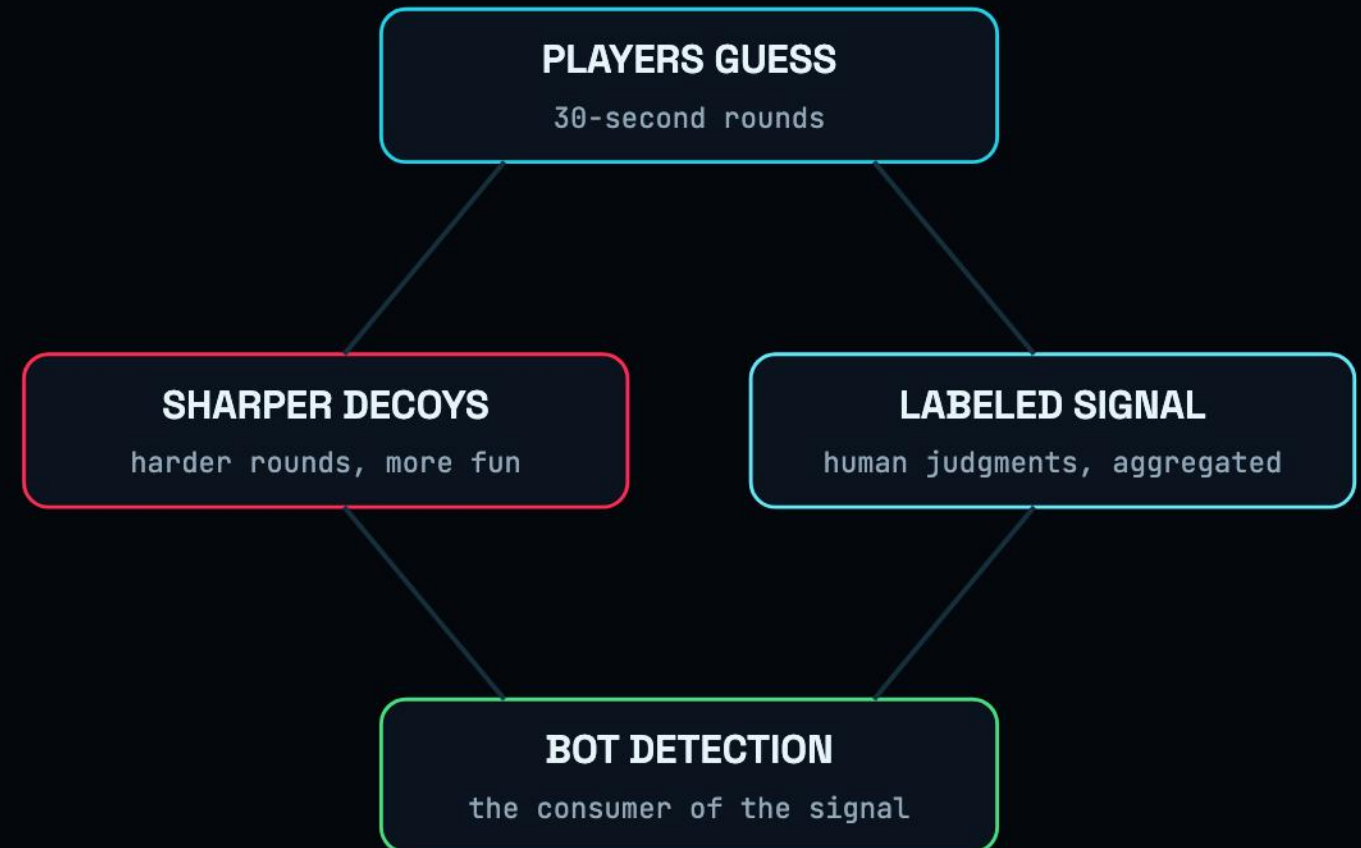
TTS PROBE

0.13s

VOICE TOKEN MINT

Every guess is a **labeled judgment**

- A guess marks which reply reads machine-written
- Wrong guesses flag real replies that read like bots
- Aggregate signal is what bot detection wants
- This is a thesis. No flywheel number is measured.



Thesis

LABELED AS SUCH

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FLYWHEEL METRICS MEASURED

One cabinet, many cartridges

- A cartridge ships rounds behind one small contract
- The cabinet runs rooms, scoring, voice, share cards
- Gates are platform infrastructure, not per-game code
- They rejected 1 of 6 rounds built 7 Aug
- Second cartridge Crux exists as a sketch

GATE	WHAT IT CHECKS
G_SOURCE	post and all 5 replies present, within length bounds
G_SLURS	denylist scan over the post and every reply
G_DECOY_COUNT	exactly one imposter, and the round points at it
G_AUTHOR	real replies carry real handles, never the decoy marker
G_URL	no links in reply text

1/6

ROUNDS REJECTED, 7 AUG

5

GATES, FAIL CLOSED

Sponsored arenas, shareable wins

- Brands sponsor topic arenas with a light skin
- The winner's share card carries the sponsor mark
- Gates screen every round before a brand touches it
- All revenue figures are illustrative, none are measured



Imagine-generated share card, a committed demo asset. The card a winner would post back to X. The demo stages that post-back rather than posting live.

Built in **a day** on the API

- Code: github.com/arunshar/x-arcade-grokathon, public, MIT
- Built 7 August, the day before this event
- Post-back and video are staged, said openly
- The ask: ship one cartridge on X, measure the flywheel

MIT

LICENSE

1 day

ON THE XAI API